
Barclays Placement Experience 2024

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About the company:

Barclays is a British multinational bank headquartered in London. It offers a wide range of financial services, including retail banking, credit cards, corporate and investment banking, and wealth management. It has been in the financial game for over 325 years, dating back to 1690 and hence has a global presence and is one of the largest banks in the world. Barclays has a strong ethical foundation and reputation for emphasising on their work culture.

P.s. Fun fact : Barclays was the first bank ever to introduce ATM and Credit cards.

Hiring role: Developer

Experience:

Online Test :

The test had MCQs based on general technical concepts, 1 coding question and 1 question based on a SQL query.

The MCQs and the SQL question were pretty straightforward and anyone with a decent knowledge of the basics could attempt them. However, the coding question was based on strings and was surprisingly the same question asked the previous year. Hence, try to go through previously asked questions, it might really help! I had gone through it and was able to pass all the test cases.

Here's the link to the question I got:

Lexicographically smallest string

Reference: <https://leetcode.com/discuss/interview-question/4006812/string-generation-oa-question/2045987>

They filtered out a majority of candidates based on the online test and finally shortlisted about 23 candidates for the interview.

Interview:

Usually, Barclays has 2 rounds of interviews: 1 technical + 1 HR.

I had an interview panel of 2 members and they merged the two rounds into 1 as we went on through the interview.

They started with some personal questions about where I studied and moved on to the technical skills I had listed right after my education qualifications on my resume. I was asked about what coding language I was comfortable with and about how I implemented certain technology like php and MySQL in my project. I proceeded to explain about my project and why I used them.

I was asked how to establish a database connection using php, different searching techniques, different python libraries, initiation of a hashmap and dictionary and if a dictionary is efficient in storing data read from a csv file and how to load a csv file in python. I was also asked the syntax for a SQL join question.

I had also elaborated a project of mine where I had incorporated Machine Learning techniques and explained the working, approach and purpose. I was asked about how to store the data more securely, I just suggested we can have a username and login password and store the data in a secure database to which they asked if I would consider encryption as a good approach. I did say yes and that it would be effective since even if anyone unauthorised gets access to data, they wouldn't understand it.

We moved on to another project where I had mentioned I had lead a team of 5 developers in creating a mobile application. After explaining the tech stack, they moved on to question how I was able to manage the team, what tools I used to keep track of everything and to suggest one, I suggested Notion. They also asked me if I had heard about 'Jira', it is a project management software, which I learned later on.

They collectively decided to move to the HR round right then and asked me about the Company values, it is RISES [Respect, Integrity, Service, Excellence and Stewardship]. It is common knowledge that Barclays give high importance to their values and expect anyone who attends the interview to be aware of it.

They asked me in depth about my personal experience with each of the values and some behavioural questions before wrapping up the interview. I asked them a couple of questions about their role and what they like about the company, which they were more than happy to answer.

I was done with my interview in the morning and spent the rest of the day anxiously waiting for the results. They finally selected 5 candidates and I was beyond elated to be one of them.

Preparation strategy and tips:

As you can see, my projects were given the utmost importance. So be 100% thorough with the projects and achievements/roles you list on your resume.

And ofcourse, keep your knowledge of basic technical concepts toned, practice leetcode, go through previous year experiences of other candidates to be prepared best and more importantly be confident in how you deliver anything.

All the best!!